



PILLAR 3

SOLAR INDUSTRY ISSUES

**“If you think it’s expensive to hire
a professional, wait until you
hire an amateur.”**

— RED ADAIR

If cheap doesn’t feel dangerous, the deal dies on price.



SOLAR INDUSTRY ISSUES

Pillar 3 of 12 • Presentation

THE GOAL

Get them genuinely concerned about the industry. By the end of this pillar they should be thinking:

“Wow — I wasn’t aware how bad this industry actually is, and how detrimental it could be if I get the wrong system or something goes wrong.”

This pillar’s job is the problem. Pillar 4 (Company Credibility) is where you become the answer. Don’t try to do both here.

THIS IS ONE OF THE MOST IMPORTANT PILLARS IN THE WHOLE PRESENTATION.

If you get a price objection at the end, or they tell you they want to shop around for something cheaper — it’s because you didn’t execute this pillar well. They didn’t fully understand the risk of going cheap, so cheap still felt like a smart option. Done right, this pillar kills both objections before they can form.

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Pre-handles “I’ll just go cheap.”** The #1 way deals get lost — they shop around for the cheapest quote. This pillar makes “cheap” feel dangerous, not smart.
- **Pre-handles “I’ll shop around.”** Once they’ve heard the industry horror stories from you, every other quote they get feels suspicious by default.
- **Positions you as the honest one.** You raised the dodgy industry issue before they did — that builds massive trust.
- **Pre-seeds Pillar 4 (Company Credibility).** They now actively want trust signals. Your warranties, SLAs, reviews, etc. land much harder because they’re looking for them.
- **Pre-seeds Pillar 7 (Guarantees & Warranties).** Same effect — they now understand why warranties matter.

TONALITY (CRITICAL — MAKE OR BREAK)

GENUINELY CONCERNED, NOT PITCHING

This pillar lives or dies on tonality. If it sounds like a sales pitch attacking competitors, it backfires. If it sounds like an honest mate giving you the real warning out of care, it lands like a bomb.

- Tone is genuine concern, not aggressive selling.

- Authentic frustration with the industry comes through. You're frustrated because you've seen it — not because you're trying to sell.
- The line that anchors everything: "I tell you this because I've actually seen it happen."
- Pace slows down here. This is where you get serious. The energy shifts from "explainer" to "honest warning."
- Don't oversell or exaggerate — facts and real stories are stronger than dramatic language.

Pacing warning

Aim for impact. If they're nodding and you've made the point — and they clearly understand — move on. Going on too long makes them tune out ("alright mate, I get it").

Heavy scripting note

It's extremely important you nail this pillar — if you don't want to get a price objection or a "we'll think about it" at the end of the call, it comes down to executing this pillar well. That's why this one is scripted out in a lot more detail than the other pillars.

SLIDE 1: THE INDUSTRY PROBLEM

Walk through the industry problem in flowing beats — don't make this feel like a list. Pacing matters: you're aiming for IMPACT, not depth. If they look like they get it, move on.

Beat 1: The Pink Batts / government scheme anchor

Open Slide 1 with this anchor. It hooks them into a memory they already have of a government-funded scheme that turned into carnage. Once they're in that frame, everything you say next about the solar industry lands on already-fertile ground.

"Before we jump into this — guys, do you remember the pink batts?"

Tonality: curious. Like you're genuinely asking if they remember a piece of shared history.

Wait for the response. Almost everyone in Australia will say yes — pink batts is universally remembered. Let them tell you what they remember (deaths, house fires, the whole disaster). Their own memory does the work.

If they don't know the scheme: just explain it quickly in one or two sentences ("yeah it was a government insulation scheme that ended in deaths and a heap of house fires because random tradies were rushing the job") and move straight into solar. They still walk away with the impression that this government-funded scamming pattern happens all the time.

Regional adaptation

If outside Australia, swap pink batts for a known equivalent the customer will recognise:

- **Australia:** Pink Batts (Home Insulation Program, 2009–2010). \$2.8B Rudd government scheme. 4 installer deaths, 200+ house fires, Royal Commission. Universally remembered.
- **USA:** Cash for Clunkers (Car Allowance Rebate System, 2009). \$3B Obama stimulus. Brookings called it "more costly, less effective." Fraud cases hit immediately. Almost every American knows the name.

- **UK:** ECO4 Insulation Scheme or Spray Foam Insulation Scandal. ECO4 had a National Audit Office finding that 98% of external wall insulation was defective; £44M fraud probe. Spray foam involved cold callers, scammed pensioners, and rebranded crooks calling back to charge for removal — close to a phoenixing parallel.
- **Other regions:** Find your local equivalent — any well-known government-funded scheme that turned into a scandal. The pattern is universal.

After they respond, transition naturally into Beat 2. The pink batts memory is the perfect setup for explaining WHY the same thing is happening in solar.

Beat 2: Government funding turns it ruthless

Strong opening frame — sets up why the industry is dodgy in the first place. Keep it tight, raw, no complex words.

“The thing is — once there’s government funding involved, it gets ruthless. People lose basic human decency. They start cheating, scamming, doing whatever they can to get their hands on some government money.”

Tonality: concerned. The line should land with weight — not pitch energy.

“You’ve got one guy who’s a plumber, aircon guy, even just a random tradie. He thinks, ‘you know what, let me jump on this solar bandwagon and make a quick buck off the government too.’”

Tonality: obvious / matter-of-fact. Like you’re stating something everyone already knows.

Beat 3: Bulk from China, slapped on your roof

“And what these guys do — they just buy bulk products from China. All the racking, all the screws, all the equipment. Dirt cheap, obviously. Then throw it straight up on your roof.”

Tonality: obvious / concerned. Stating it like it’s the most predictable, frustrating thing in the world.

Beat 4: You can’t check the roof

Get the buy-in here — paint the picture and let them respond. The interactive moment matters.

“And the problem with that — think about it. Your roof’s pretty high up. You’re not going to climb up on your roof on a blistering hot summer’s day and burn your feet to double-check all your panels, are you? I know I wouldn’t.”

Tonality: playful. Light delivery, slight grin — gets them to chuckle/agree.

Wait for them to chuckle / agree. Get the verbal buy-in before continuing.

If the customer is older or frail, swap the line to: “You’re not going to fall off your roof to double-check it all, are you?” — same beat, more appropriate framing.

“So you don’t actually realise what’s gone on your roof until 2, 3, 4, 5 years down the track — when something’s gone wrong, and that company’s nowhere to be seen.”

Tonality: concerned. Voice drops back into seriousness — this is the consequence beat.

Beat 5: The phoenixing question



Plant the question and name the practice in one flowing beat. Don't split this into separate moments — it lands harder as one continuous thought.

“And the real question is — are these companies even going to be around in 2, 3, 4, 5 years from now?”

Tonality: curious. Open question — let them sit with it.

“And most importantly — because you can never 100% predict the future — if they DO go out of business, do they have something to back you up? A third-party arrangement? Insurance? Guarantees that you're actually protected no matter what?”

Tonality: curious + skeptical. The skepticism gives the question its weight — you're already implying the answer is no.

“Or are they just doing what they all do — dump the business, shut down the phones, reset under a new business name, and run the whole scam all over again?”

Tonality: obvious / matter-of-fact. Like you're describing something everyone in the industry knows happens.

“It's called phoenixing. You guys have probably heard about it by now, hey?”

Tonality: obvious. “You guys have probably heard about it by now” lands with a casual confidence — positions phoenixing as common knowledge.

Beat 6: The price differentiation pre-frame

This beat is critical — it pre-handles the price objection before the components conversation.

“And guys — you're probably wondering why there's so much variance in price when it comes to something like solar. You've probably seen on the TV or on Facebook those dirt cheap systems for \$5 or \$6K — and then the same system with another company is \$25 or \$30K.”

“You're probably thinking — what? How could there be such a price difference?”

Tonality: curious. Asked like you're genuinely wondering with them — not lecturing.

Beat 7: The components reality

“The truth is, solar is just a heap of components:”

- the panels
- the inverter
- the batteries
- the screws
- the switches
- the backing
- the railing
- the cabling
- the conduit



Don't drone through every item — read them with momentum, like you're listing them off the top of your head.

"All of it. The only way you can ever really go cheap is by directly sacrificing the components that have gone on your roof. There's no other way to do it."

Tonality: certainty. Said like a fact — not a sales pitch.

"And inevitably, cheap stuff doesn't last. You guys know the story — you buy cheap, you pay the price later."

Tonality: obvious. Like you're stating something everyone already knows is true.

Beat 8: The 'we're not dirt cheap' pre-frame

Drop this at the end of Slide 1. Pre-handles every "yours is more expensive" objection before they even ask. Honest, confident, non-defensive — and pre-seeds Pillar 7 (Guarantees & Warranties) at the same time.

Tonality (whole beat): genuine + sincere. This whole thing only works if it sounds completely honest. Drop the sales energy entirely — talk to them like a mate giving them straight advice.

"And guys — I'm gonna be very transparent with you. I'm pretty open. We're not gonna be the dirt cheapest out there in the industry. We would never be. To be honest, you don't actually want us to be dirt cheap."

"If we were dirt cheap, we wouldn't have been around for the past [X] years. We wouldn't plan to be around for the next 25 to 50. We wouldn't have all these guarantees and warranties put in place to protect you no matter what."

"That's why I raise this at the start — just to make sure you pick a long-term company that genuinely cares about you guys. Makes sense?"

Wait for the soft yes. The 'makes sense?' close commits them to the principle before you ever talk price — once they've agreed long-term + cared-for is what matters, dirt cheap is off the table for them.

Transition into Slide 2 (the fire risk)

After Slide 1 closes with the 'we're not dirt cheap' pre-frame, use the news as the natural bridge into the fire slide. Two-step question — first watching habits, then the fires.

Step 1: Do you watch the news?

"By the way — do you guys still watch the news these days?"

Tonality: curious. Genuine question, no agenda.

Let them answer. If they say no — "that's all good, most people don't." If they say yes — "mmm" / acknowledge and move into Step 2.

Step 2: Are you familiar with the fires?

"Are you familiar with all the fires that have been happening from the solar?"



Tonality: curious. 'Are you familiar with' lands softer than 'have you seen' — feels less accusatory and more genuinely curious.

Wait for the answer. Whatever they say, it sets up Slide 2 — most will say no or just a bit, which is the gap you fill on the slide.

SLIDE 2: THE FIRE RISK

This slide carries the safety angle. Heaviest emotional content of the pillar — pace slows down, voice gets serious. Don't rush.

Beat 1: The setup

Fire question already asked in the transition. Now you confirm and explain.

“Yeah — there's actually been a heavy increase in house fires directly from poorly installed solar systems.”

Tonality: certainty. State it as fact — no hedging, no overselling.

Whatever they answered in the transition ('yeah a bit' / 'no, not really'), this lands as either confirmation or new information — both work.

Beat 2: The TV ads / cheap brands

Reference back to what you mentioned in Slide 1 (Beat 6 — Price Differentiation). Builds continuity and gets a quick yes.

“Guys, you know how we were just talking about those cheap \$5–6K systems, usually with the old sports stars or a paid celebrity pushing their brand?”

Tonality: certainty / casual. Reference back to what they already nodded to.

Most will say yes — they remember it from a few minutes ago. Once they're nodding, you've got their full attention.

Beat 3: How they get the price that low

“Let me explain something. One way they get the price that low — beyond using the cheapest equipment — is using unlicensed installers. For example, they'll have one electrician on the job, but the rest are apprentices. Or two apprentices not using proper techniques, rushing the jobs.”

“That's how the cost comes down. And that's why the installations go by the wayside and aren't done properly.”

Tonality: certainty. You're explaining how the industry actually works — straight facts, no drama. The mechanism speaks for itself.

Beat 4: The real mechanism + family safety stake

Skip the news clip — go straight into the technical mechanism, then land on family safety. The specifics make it concrete and credible.

“After all that, if water or condensation gets into the isolator switches, it can arc the cabling inside. That can cause a fire — literally burns the whole house down and ruins everything.”



Tonality: certainty. Explain the mechanism plainly — like you're walking them through how something actually works.

"That's your family's safety at stake, guys. It can actually ruin people's lives."

Tonality: serious but sincere. Slow down here. Voice gets quieter, not louder. Genuine concern, not theatrical.

"I bring this up because this is genuinely something that's happening — it's on the news, unfortunately apparent day-to-day in our environment."

Tonality: sincere. The 'I bring this up because' line is what positions you as concerned, not pitching. Let it land before going into Beat 5.

Beat 5: The emotional anchor

This is the moment of authentic frustration. Slow down, mean every word.

Tonality (whole beat): genuine + sincere. This is the most emotionally weighted moment in the pillar. Don't perform it — feel it. Slow pace, voice quieter not louder.

"If you knew how much it upsets me that there are companies out there with no integrity — companies that aren't going to be there for you when things go wrong... it's a shame to me that I have to work in an industry that's been tarnished by these people who come in just to make a quick buck and then disappear."

"They leave families with all sorts of problems, fires, you name it. I've spoken to people who've been through this exact thing — and they don't want to do solar at all anymore. They don't trust solar, because of what happened to them."

Pause after this. Let it land. The silence is part of the impact.

SLIDE 3: CHEAP SOLAR (AVOID THE 3 SOLAR MISTAKES)

This is the cheap solar slide that follows the fire slide. By this point you've hit them with two very hard slides — don't go too deep or over-explain here. Walk the visuals, point things out, and have a genuine conversation.

Beat 1: Walk the visuals

Reference what they're seeing on the slide. Light, conversational tone — not another heavy beat.

"You can see here how much solar actually ends up in waste. When you get these dodgy jobs where they don't even do solar properly — leaving cables out, panels uneven — you just see some horror stories."

Tonality: concerned. Light delivery — but the concern is real, not theatrical.

Beat 2: Read the quote

Read the quote on the slide with certainty — straight delivery, no embellishment.



“A quality solar system pays for itself. A cheap one ends up in landfill. Yet thousands of homeowners still make the same mistake — buying twice. Cheap first, then properly second.”

“It’s a real thing — we always say to people: ‘hey, you can do it dirt cheap if you want.’ The problem is you just end up coming back, having to get it redone the proper way 2, 3, 4, 5 years from now when the system breaks down.”

“Just save yourself the hassle, save yourself time and money, and get it right from the start. It’s a lot less stress that way.”

Tonality: genuine + sincere. The ‘save yourself the hassle’ close is straight-talk advice — like a mate steering you away from a bad decision.

Beat 3: Bridge into the 25% stat

Flows directly from Beat 2 — ‘even if you look at this stat here’ connects the principle to the proof.

“Even if you look at this stat here — it’s pretty crazy actually. 25% of every installation we do, we actually have to rip a cheap or poorly installed system off the roof.”

Tonality: shocked. Said like even YOU still can’t believe the number — even though you’ve seen it firsthand.

“That’s 1 in 4 families that unknowingly got scammed.”

Tonality: concerned. Voice drops. The word ‘scammed’ lands harder when it’s quiet, not loud.

Brief pause. The number speaks for itself — flow straight into the Long-Term Thinking pre-frame as the close of this slide.

Beat 4: The long-term thinking pre-frame

Drop this at the end of Slide 3. It does identity-based work — frames the customer as someone who thinks long-term (not like the “average person”). Once they’ve quietly agreed they’re not average, they have to make the long-term choice to stay consistent with that identity.

The pre-frame

Tonality (whole pre-frame): genuine + concerned + sincere. This is honest advice from someone who’s seen it go wrong too many times — not a sales technique. The customer can feel the difference instantly.

“Because unfortunately the average person just struggles to think long-term. That’s a sad thing. They see a system that’s a little bit cheaper and think, ‘oh, yup, I’ll grab that one.’ Or they genuinely can’t afford it. Or they even get tricked by one of those dodgy companies. Just sucks to see so many people who genuinely get ripped off badly.”

“Honestly — just find yourself a company that actually cares about you and is going to take care of you long-term. Guys, as long as they’re not unfairly priced, it still works out less than what you’re paying on power anyway, and everything else looks good, why would you even risk going cheap?”

Wait for the response. By this point, almost everyone says some version of ‘no, I’d never go cheap’ — they’ve now committed to the principle in their own words. That’s the lock-in.

Why this works

- **Empathetic, not condescending.** Acknowledging that people get tricked, can't afford it, or just struggle with long-term thinking lets the customer relate without feeling judged. They're not the 'average' person being talked down to — they're the smart one you're warning.
- **You're categorising, not bragging.** Not 'we're great.' It's 'smart people pick a company that actually cares.' Subtle but powerful.
- **Pre-handles 'yours is more expensive.'** The line about 'as long as they're not unfairly priced, ours actually still works out less than what you're paying on power' sets up the value frame before they ever see your price.
- **The 'why would you even risk going cheap?' close is the lock-in.** Almost everyone responds with some version of 'no, I'd never go cheap.' Now they've committed to the principle in their own words — and you can't talk someone out of their own commitment.

SLIDE 4: NO POST-INSTALL SUPPORT (AVOID THE 3 SOLAR MISTAKES #3)

This slide compares responsive ongoing support ("You want this") vs being ghosted ("Not this"). Lighter on doom than Slides 2 and 3 — this is where you start showing them what the right relationship with a solar company actually looks like, while pre-seeding Pillars 4 and 7. Pace stays conversational.

Beat 1: Pre-frame the slide

Open by linking this slide directly to the warranty reveal coming later in the slide. Frames everything in between as setup for the good news.

"Okay guys, this slide is really important — it's actually linked to one of our guarantees that I want to tell you about."

"As you know — with us, the relationship starts after you get installed. That ongoing relationship is everything. It's a 25-year partnership."

"The problem in this industry is that once you sign up with most companies, you just become a number. If you have a problem — you wait in the queue. I think you just blindly wait in the queue to see if they ever actually end up helping you."

Beat 2: Skin in the game (direct question)

Direct question that gets them mentally answering on the company's behalf — exposes the structural conflict of interest.

"Think about it — if a company doesn't have any skin in the game, what do you think they're going to do? Prioritise new installations that are making them more and more money? Or come out and deal with all the problems of your poorly installed system when something goes wrong?"

"You tell me."

Pause. Let them answer or nod. They know the answer — getting them to say it (or think it) is the point.

Beat 3: Solar is long-term — honest acknowledgement

Honest framing — over 25 years, things will come up. Builds trust by not over-promising perfection.

“Now we know solar is a long-term investment, and sometimes problems do occur. I’ll be honest with you — over 25 years, you might have 1 or 2 things that come up that we can help with.”

Beat 4: The inverter example (with the China line)

Concrete scenario that makes the abstract ‘poor support’ real. The China line is a light moment that breaks tension before the SLA reveal — only use if it lands naturally.

“Let’s just say, for example — your inverter stops working 5 years down the track. What happens normally is you call up.”

“If that company is still around and the number still rings, they’ll pick up and put you in the queue. Or even worse — they’ll decide they’re not helping with it, leaving you to call China directly to fix it yourself.”

“And just from chatting with you guys so far — it doesn’t look like you speak Mandarin to me...”
[chuckle]

Light moment — chuckle, give them space to laugh. The humour breaks tension and makes the SLA reveal land harder when you pivot. If the customer’s mood doesn’t suit a joke, drop the China bit and go straight to the SLA pivot.

Beat 5: The good news pivot

Bridges from the doom into the SLA reveal. Lands the SLA as relief, not as a sales feature.

“But you guys are probably thinking — ‘okay [name], you’ve told me all this bad news about the industry. Surely you’ve got to have some good news for me?’”

“Yeah — I’ve actually got something for you.”

Brief pause. The question + the pivot is what makes the SLA land — they’re now leaning in for the answer instead of being pitched at.

Beat 6: The 25-year SLA

Walk through the full 25-year SLA. This pre-seeds Pillar 7 (Guarantees & Warranties) — keep it conversational here, you’ll go deeper on warranties later. Adapt year/day numbers to your company.

“We have something put in place — one of our warranties — that I think is going to genuinely resonate with you guys. It’s a 25-year Service Level Agreement.”

“What that means is — for the 25 years your system is on the roof — that’s your solar, your battery, your inverter, the cables, the switches, the racking, every single part of the system — we actually guarantee it will never go down for the full 25 years.”

“And if it ever does, we’ll come out to fix it within [X] days. If we take longer than that, we pay you out of our own pocket — all lost savings, your bill, everything covered. Until it’s fixed.”

“And the thing about this is — if we were using crap, if we were using rubbish, if we weren’t confident in our stuff — we’d be shooting ourselves in the foot here. We’d be the ones losing

money. We'd be the ones having to replace it. We'd be the ones having to send people out."

"So it's just sort of a testament to the quality of our stuff as well."

Tonality: certainty + casual confidence. This beat is the structural argument — the SLA proves we believe in our own stuff because we'd be financially destroyed if we were using cheap gear.

Beat 7: What this actually protects

Closes the slide with the emotional payoff — why the 25-year SLA exists in the first place. The check-in goes at the very end.

"And the reason we do that, guys — we don't want you to do solar and have it break every couple of years. You know — you have problems with the inverter, your battery, the bills start creeping back in, everything like that."

"We just want you to know you've put it up, you've done it right, you've picked a quality company. There's going to be no problems for 25 years."

"That's the whole point of this warranty, guys — just to protect you and put your mind at ease always."

"Does that make sense?"

Wait for the response. The check-in here gives them permission to push back on the slide before moving on — much better than letting concerns surface at the close.

FAILURE MODES (DO NOT DO)

- **Sounding like you're attacking competitors.** Tone is concern, not aggression. 'These dodgy companies' not 'those losers at [Competitor X].'
- **Going too long on the doom.** The pillar should escalate and land — not drone on. If they've felt the weight, move forward.
- **Pulling punches on the fire / safety angle.** This is the part that makes them act. Don't soften it because it feels intense — intense is the point.
- **Banging them over the head with it again and again.** If you can tell they're getting it and they want to move on — move on. Staying in rapport with them is the most important thing. Coverage is not the goal — IMPACT is.
- **Performing the emotion.** Theatrical concern reads as fake. Genuine concern reads because it's genuine.
- **Asking them 'why wouldn't YOU go cheap?' after the long-term pre-frame.** They've already answered it implicitly — asking again creates sales resistance. Move on.
- **Skipping the long-term pre-frame on Slide 3.** It's the lock-in. Without their commitment to 'I'd never go cheap,' the rest of the presentation has to fight harder to hold them.

TRANSITION INTO PILLAR 4 (COMPANY CREDIBILITY)



After they've agreed they wouldn't risk going cheap (via the Long-Term Pre-Frame), the natural next move is to show them who actually does it right. Pillar 4 picks up exactly here — "and this is why we exist, and this is what makes us different."

No hard verbal switch needed. The customer is now actively looking for a company they can trust — Pillar 4 fills that gap.

Remember: this pillar's job is to make "cheap" feel dangerous. If you don't kill it here, the price objection will be waiting at the close.